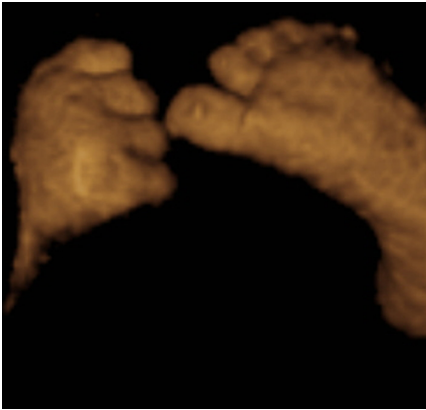




YOU ARE **39 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

3 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

This image shows that even at this time your baby will be able to reach down and touch their toes (see the foot on the right and the hand on the left). Because there is less space your baby will no longer be able to place their feet on top of their head.

“Don’t be too concerned if your baby hasn’t engaged yet since this won’t have any bearing on the final delivery date.”

There are many reasons why your baby may not have engaged yet: the shape of your pelvis may mean that you need the pressure of the contractions to get the baby’s head to engage. Second and subsequent babies tend to engage later because the abdominal muscles are very loose, so the baby may move freely without feeling any need to get her head down.

There is also a small possibility that the baby’s head has not engaged because the head is too big to enter the birth canal. This can only be confirmed once labor has started.

HOW YOUR BABY IS POSITIONED

Once the baby is head down and moves into the pelvis there are several positions she may adopt: six of the most common are shown below. The position is determined by where her back and occiput (the back of her head) are lying. The most usual position is LOT. If the baby is breech (see [Breech baby](#)), the position is determined by how the bottom is lying.